

MAX LUBELL

University of Texas at Austin | Department of Sociology
mlubell@utexas.edu

Education

- Exp. 2027 PhD, Sociology, University of Texas at Austin
Graduate Student Trainee, Population Research Center
National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellow
- Dissertation: “Eyes on the Cul-de-sac: Suburban Neighborhood Change and Digitally-Mediated Citizen Surveillance”
Committee: Javier Auyero, Sarah Brayne (Stanford University), Chantal Hailey, Michael Sierra-Arévalo
- 2023 MA, Sociology, University of Texas at Austin
- 2018 BA, Sociology (Highest Honors & *magna cum laude*), University of Michigan

Publications

Max Lubell, Nour Abdul-Razzak, and Kelly Hallberg. Forthcoming. “Overcoming Distrust: Organizational Brokerage, Social Tie Formation, and System Avoidance in a Community Violence Intervention.” *Social Problems*.

Max Lubell. 2026. “Gunshots or Fireworks? Tracing the Spatial Diffusion of Digital Participatory Surveillance.” *City & Community*. OnlineFirst.

Vijay F. Chillar, **Max Lubell**, Kateryna Kaplun, and Michael Sierra-Arévalo. 2026. “The Police-Industrial Complex: An Analysis of Police Vendors at the International Association of Chiefs of Police (IACP) Annual Conference, 2012-2018.” *Police Practice and Research*.

Bhatt, Monica P., Jonathan Guryan, Harold A. Pollack, Juan C. Castrejon, Molly Clark, Lucia Delgado-Sanchez, Phoebe Lin, **Max Lubell**, Cristobal Pinto Poehls, Ben Shaver, and Makenzi Sumners. 2023. “Randomized Evaluation of a School-Based, Trauma-Informed Group Intervention for Young Women in Chicago.” *Science Advances* 9(23).

Revise & Resubmit

Max Lubell. “The Digitally Defended Neighborhood: Suburban Racial Threat, Criminalization, and Legitimizing Insecurity.” Second R&R at *American Journal of Sociology*

- ASA Race, Gender, and Class Section: Semi-finalist Graduate Student Paper Award, 2026

Work in Progress

Max Lubell. “How to Beat the Surveillance Machine.” Submitted.

Max Lubell. “Academic Engagement and Homicide Exposure across Multi-Neighborhood Contexts.”

- ASA Community and Urban Sociology Section: Graduate Student Paper Award, 2025

Max Lubell. “Containing Civilian Force: Police Perspectives on Civilian Gun Ownership and Home Surveillance.”

Michael Sierra-Arévalo, **Max Lubell**, Nicholas Weller, Harry Muttram, Jose Alcocer, Benjamin A.T. Graham. “Error in police-generated data significantly underestimates pretext stop rates.”

Nour Abdul-Razzak, Brandon Domash, Max Kapustin, **Max Lubell**. “Providing Intensive Wraparound Supports for Disengaged Chicago Youth: A Randomized Evaluation.”

Other Writing

Max Lubell. “Environmental Evacuation is a Collective Problem.” *Edge Effects*. 2022.

- Republished by *Society for Social Studies of Science*, 2022

Fellowships, Grants, & Awards

External

2026	Horowitz Foundation for Social Policy Dissertation Grant (\$10,000)
2026	Student Research Award, ASA Crime, Law, and Deviance Section (\$500)
2025	Graduate Student Paper Award, ASA Community and Urban Sociology Section
2024	Emergent Scholar Fellowship, Arizona State University BRIDGS center (\$1,500)
2022-26	Graduate Research Fellowship, National Science Foundation (\$147,000)

Internal

2024	Forbes Fellowship, UT Austin Population Research Center (\$1,500)
2022-26	Dean’s Prestigious Fellowship Supplement, UT Austin College of Liberal Arts (\$9,000)
2018	Robert Cooley Angell Award (Top Undergraduate Thesis), University of Michigan Department of Sociology (\$500)

Presentations

“The Digitally Defended Neighborhood”

- 2026 American Sociological Association Meeting (Crime, Law, and Deviance Regular Session; New York)
- 2026 Society for the Study of Social Problems Meeting (Law and Society Thematic Session; New York)
- 2026 Law and Society Association Meeting (San Francisco)
- 2026 Population Association of America Meeting (Poster Session; Saint Louis)

“Containing Civilian Force”

- 2026 Arizona State University, Guns in Society Symposium (Phoenix)

“Across the Thin Blue Line: Cultural Transmission of Criminal Threats”

- 2025 Institute for Urban Policy Research and Analysis, Symposium on Race and Policing in American Cities (Austin)

“How Community Violence Interventions Develop Social Ties in Heavily Policed Neighborhoods”

- 2025 American Sociological Association Meeting (Law and Society Regular Session; Montreal)
- 2024 Law and Society Association Meeting (Denver)

“How Threats of Violence Shape Academic Achievement”

- 2024 American Sociological Association Meeting (Crime, Law, and Deviance Roundtable; Montreal)
- 2024 ASA Community and Urban Sociology Section Online Mini-Conference

“Adolescent Exposure to Firearm-related Violence and Educational Attainment”

- 2023 American Sociological Association Meeting (Sociology of Education Roundtable; Philadelphia)

“Stigma Against Gentrifiers?”

- 2018 University of Michigan Sociology Department Honors Colloquium (Ann Arbor)

Teaching Experience

UT Extension, Assistant Instructor (Texas Prison Education Initiative)

Spring 2025	Punishment and Society
Spring 2024	Education and Society
Fall 2023	Introduction to the Study of Society

UT Austin Department of Sociology, Teaching Assistant

Fall 2021	Introduction to Social Statistics
Spring 2022	Social Research Methods

Professional Service

2026	Roundtable Discussant, ASA Community and Urban Sociology Section
2026	Graduate Mentor, PRC Research Experience for Undergraduates
2022 – Present	Volunteer Instructor and Program Coordinator (Former), Texas Prison Education Initiative
2023 – Present	Graduate Student Peer Mentor, UT Austin Sociology Department
2025 – 2026	Post-candidacy Representative, UT Austin Sociology Graduate Student Committee
2024 – 2025	Chair, Sociology Graduate Student Committee
2023	Publicly Engaged Scholar Award Committee Member, ASA Community and Urban Sociology Section

Ad-Hoc Reviewer: *Sociological Perspectives*

Professional Experience

2018 – 2021	Research Manager, University of Chicago Crime Lab and Education Lab
2017 – 2018	Bibliographic Research Assistant, University of Michigan Institute for Social Research
2016 – 2018	Research Assistant & Course Consultant, University of Michigan Sociology Department